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United States Patent	12407316
Kind Code	B2
Date of Patent	September 02, 2025
Inventor(s)	Yamamoto; Arata

Multilayered filter device

Abstract

A multilayered filter device includes a first port, a second port, a first LC resonator electrically connected to the first port, a second LC resonator electrically connected to the second port, a third LC resonator provided between the first LC resonator and the second LC resonator in a circuit configuration, and a stack. The first LC resonator includes a first inductor. The second LC resonator includes a second inductor. The first inductor and the second inductor are configured to be magnetically coupled inside the stack.

Inventors:	Yamamoto; Arata (Tokyo, JP)
Applicant:	TDK CORPORATION (Tokyo, JP)
Family ID:	88078960
Assignee:	TDK CORPORATION (Tokyo, JP)
Appl. No.:	18/179600
Filed:	March 07, 2023

Prior Publication Data

Document Identifier	Publication Date
US 20230327631 A1	Oct. 12, 2023

Foreign Application Priority Data

JP	2022-047842	Mar. 24, 2022
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Publication Classification

Int. Cl.: H03H7/01 (20060101); H03H7/09 (20060101); H03H1/00 (20060101)

U.S. Cl.:

CPC **H03H7/0115** (20130101); **H03H7/09** (20130101); **H03H7/1791** (20130101);
H03H2001/0085 (20130101)

Field of Classification Search

CPC: H03H (2001/0085); H03H (7/0115); H03H (7/09)

USPC: 333/175; 333/185

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Primary Examiner: Patel; Rakesh B

Attorney, Agent or Firm: Oliff PLC

Background/Summary

CROSS REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS

(1) This application claims the benefit of Japanese Priority Patent Application No. 2022-047842 filed on Mar. 24, 2022, the entire contents of which are incorporated herein by reference.

BACKGROUND OF THE INVENTION

1. Field of the Invention

(2) The present invention relates to a multilayered filter device including an LC resonator.

2. Description of the Related Art

(3) One of electronic components used in a communication apparatus is a band-pass filter including a plurality of resonators. Each of the resonators is an LC resonator composed of an inductor and a

capacitor, for example.

(4) A band-pass filter that is used for a small-sized communication apparatus in particular is required to be downsized. One known example of a band-pass filter suitable for downsizing is a band-pass filter using a stack including a plurality of insulating layers and a plurality of conductor layers stacked together.

(5) US 2015/0028969 A1 discloses a band-pass filter including a stack constituted by stacking a plurality of dielectric layers. This band-pass filter includes a plurality of parallel resonant circuits composed of inductors and capacitors.

(6) One of favorable characteristics of a band-pass filter is that insertion loss changes sharply at a frequency range near a cut-off frequency. Such a characteristic can be implemented, for example, by generating an attenuation pole at the frequency range near the cut-off frequency in the pass characteristic of the band-pass filter.

(7) Attenuation poles can typically be adjusted using the resonant frequencies of resonators. However, LC resonators have the problem that the characteristic of changing sharply in attenuation near an attenuation pole is difficult to implement. For such a reason, it has heretofore been difficult to generate an attenuation pole at a frequency range near a cut-off frequency while maintaining a desirable pass characteristic in the passband.

SUMMARY OF THE INVENTION

(8) An object of the present invention is to provide a multilayered filter device including an LC resonator, and having a pass characteristic that changes sharply at a frequency range near a cut-off frequency.

(9) A multilayered filter device according to the present invention includes a first port, a second port, a first LC resonator electrically connected to the first port, a second LC resonator electrically connected to the second port, a third LC resonator provided between the first LC resonator and the second LC resonator in a circuit configuration, and a stack. The stack includes a plurality of dielectric layers stacked together, and is intended to integrate the first port, the second port, the first LC resonator, the second LC resonator, and the third LC resonator. The first LC resonator includes a first inductor. The second LC resonator includes a second inductor. The first inductor and the second inductor are configured to be magnetically coupled inside the stack.

(10) In the multilayered filter device according to the present invention, the first inductor and the second inductor may adjoin inside the stack.

(11) In the multilayered filter device according to the present invention, the first inductor may include two first through hole lines and a first conductor layer connecting the two first through hole lines. The second inductor may include two second through hole lines and a second conductor layer connecting the two second through hole lines. Each of the two first through hole lines and the two second through hole lines may be formed by connecting two or more through holes in series. There may be no conductor between the two first through hole lines and the two second through hole lines. A first region sandwiched between the two first through hole lines and a second region sandwiched between the two second through hole lines may overlap with each other when seen in a direction orthogonal to a stacking direction of the plurality of dielectric layers. The first conductor layer and the second conductor layer may not overlap with each other when seen in a direction parallel to the stacking direction of the plurality of dielectric layers. The first conductor layer may include a portion that extends in a direction away from the second conductor layer. The second conductor layer may include a portion that extends in a direction away from the first conductor layer.

(12) If the first inductor includes the first conductor layer and the second inductor includes the second conductor layer, the third LC resonator may include a third inductor. The third inductor may include a third conductor layer. The third conductor layer may overlap a region where the first conductor layer or the second conductor layer is located when seen in the direction parallel to the stacking direction of the plurality of dielectric layers. In such a case, the stack may have a first

surface opposed to a body to be mounted, and a second surface opposite the first surface. The third conductor layer may be located between the first conductor layer or the second conductor layer and the first surface.

(13) In the multilayered filter device according to the present invention, each of the first LC resonator and the second LC resonator may constitute a low-pass filter. The third LC resonator may constitute a high-pass filter.

(14) In the multilayered filter device according to the present invention, the first inductor and the second inductor are configured to be magnetically coupled inside the stack. According to the present invention, a multilayered filter device having a pass characteristic that changes sharply at a frequency range near a cut-off frequency can thus be provided.

(15) Other and further objects, features and advantages of the present invention will appear more fully from the following description.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

(1) FIG. 1 is a circuit diagram showing a circuit configuration of a multilayered filter device according to an embodiment of the present invention.

(2) FIG. 2 is a perspective view showing an external appearance of the multilayered filter device according to the embodiment of the present invention.

(3) FIG. 3A to FIG. 3C are explanatory diagrams showing respective patterned surfaces of first to third dielectric layers of a stack of the multilayered filter device according to the embodiment of the present invention.

(4) FIG. 4A to FIG. 4C are explanatory diagrams showing respective patterned surfaces of fourth to sixth dielectric layers of the stack of the multilayered filter device according to the embodiment of the present invention.

(5) FIG. 5A is an explanatory diagram showing a patterned surface of a seventh dielectric layer of the stack of the multilayered filter device according to the embodiment of the present invention.

(6) FIG. 5B is an explanatory diagram showing a patterned surface of an eighth dielectric layer of the stack of the multilayered filter device according to the embodiment of the present invention.

(7) FIG. 5C is an explanatory diagram showing a patterned surface of ninth to fourteenth dielectric layers of the stack of the multilayered filter device according to the embodiment of the present invention.

(8) FIG. 6A to FIG. 6C are explanatory diagrams showing respective patterned surfaces of fifteenth to seventeenth dielectric layers of the stack of the multilayered filter device according to the embodiment of the present invention.

(9) FIG. 7A to FIG. 7C are explanatory diagrams showing respective patterned surfaces of eighteenth to twentieth dielectric layers of the stack of the multilayered filter device according to the embodiment of the present invention.

(10) FIG. 8A is an explanatory diagram showing a patterned surface of a twenty-first dielectric layer of the stack of the multilayered filter device according to the embodiment of the present invention.

(11) FIG. 8B is an explanatory diagram showing a patterned surface of a twenty-second dielectric layer of the stack of the multilayered filter device according to the embodiment of the present invention.

(12) FIG. 8C is an explanatory diagram showing a patterned surface of twenty-third and twenty-fourth dielectric layers of the stack of the multilayered filter device according to the embodiment of the present invention.

(13) FIG. 9A to FIG. 9C are explanatory diagrams showing respective patterned surfaces of

twenty-fifth to twenty-seventh dielectric layers of the stack of the multilayered filter device according to the embodiment of the present invention.

(14) FIG. 10 is a perspective view showing an internal structure of the stack of the multilayered filter device according to the embodiment of the present invention.

(15) FIG. 11 is a perspective view showing an internal structure of the stack of the multilayered filter device according to the embodiment of the present invention.

(16) FIG. 12 is a characteristic chart showing a pass characteristic obtained by simulation.

(17) FIG. 13 is an enlarged characteristic chart showing a part of FIG. 12.

(18) FIG. 14 is an enlarged characteristic chart showing a part of FIG. 12.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION OF THE PREFERRED EMBODIMENTS

(19) An embodiment of the present invention will be described below in detail with reference to the drawings. A configuration of a multilayered filter device (hereinafter, referred to simply as a filter device) 1 according to the embodiment of the present invention will initially be outlined with reference to FIG. 1. FIG. 1 shows a band-pass filter as an example of the filter device 1. The filter device 1 includes a first port 2, a second port 3, and LC resonators 11, 12, 13, and 14. Each of the first and second ports 2 and 3 is a port for inputting or outputting a signal.

(20) The LC resonator 11 is electrically connected to the first port 2. The LC resonator 14 is electrically connected to the second port 3. The LC resonators 12 and 13 are provided between the LC resonators 11 and 14 in such order from the LC resonator 11 side in a circuit configuration. Note that, in the present application, the expression “in the (a) circuit configuration” is used to indicate not a layout in a physical configuration but a layout in a circuit diagram.

(21) The LC resonator 11 corresponds to the “first LC resonator” in the present invention. The LC resonator 14 corresponds to the “second LC resonator” in the present invention. The LC resonators 12 and 13 each correspond to the “third LC resonator” in the present invention.

(22) The LC resonator 11 includes an inductor L11 and a capacitor C11. The LC resonator 12 includes an inductor L12 and a capacitor C12. The LC resonator 13 includes an inductor L13 and a capacitor C13. The LC resonator 14 includes an inductor L14 and a capacitor C14. In particular, in the present embodiment, the inductor and the capacitor in each of the LC resonators 11 to 14 are connected in parallel. As will be described in detail later, the inductor L11 and the inductor L14 are configured to be magnetically coupled with each other.

(23) An example of other circuit configuration of the filter device 1 will be described below with reference to FIG. 1. The filter device 1 further includes inductors L1, L2, and L3, and capacitors C1, C2, C3, C4, C5, C6, C7, C8, C9, and C10. One end of the inductor L1 is connected to the first port 2. One end of the inductor L11 is connected to the other end of the inductor L1. The capacitor C11 is connected in parallel with the inductor L11. One end of the capacitor C1 is connected to the one end of the inductor L11. One end of the capacitor C2 is connected to the other end of the inductor L11.

(24) One end of the capacitor C3 is connected to the other end of the inductor L11. One end of the capacitor C4 is connected to the other end of the capacitor C3. One end of the capacitor C5 is connected to the other end of the capacitor C4. One end of the inductor L12 is connected to the connection point between the capacitors C3 and C4. One end of the inductor L13 is connected to the connection point between the capacitors C4 and C5. The capacitor C12 is connected in parallel with the inductor L12. The capacitor C13 is connected in parallel with the inductor L13.

(25) One end of the inductor L14 is connected to the other end of the capacitor C5. One end of the inductor L2 is connected to the other end of the inductor L14. The other end of the inductor L2 is connected to the second port 3. The capacitor C14 is connected in parallel with the inductor L14. One end of the capacitor C6 is connected to the one end of the inductor L14. One end of the capacitor C7 is connected to the other end of the inductor L14.

(26) One end of each of the capacitors C8 and C10 is connected to the connection point between the inductor L11 and the capacitor C3. The other end of the capacitor C8 is connected to the

connection point between the capacitors C4 and C5. One end of the capacitor C9 is connected to the connection point between the capacitors C3 and C4. The other ends of the capacitors C9 and C10 are connected to the connection point between the capacitor C5 and the inductor L14.

(27) One end of the inductor L3 is connected to the other ends of the inductors L12 and L13 and the capacitors C1, C2, C6, and C7. The other end of the inductor L3 is grounded.

(28) The LC resonator 11 and the capacitors C1 and C2 constitute a low-pass filter. The LC resonators 12 and 13 and the capacitors C.sub.3 to C.sub.5 and C8 to C10 constitute a high-pass filter. The LC resonator 14 and the capacitors C6 and C7 constitute a low-pass filter. The filter device 1 is a band-pass filter including the two low-pass filters and the one high-pass filter in combination.

(29) Possible modes of electrical connection of an LC resonator to a port include one where the LC resonator is directly connected to the port via a conductor and one where the LC resonator is connected to the port via an inductor. By contrast, a mode where the conductor on the path connecting the LC resonator and the port is disconnected, like where the LC resonator is connected to the port via a capacitor, is not included in the modes of electrical connection of the LC resonator to the port.

(30) In the present embodiment, the one end of each of the inductor L11 and the capacitor C11 of the LC resonator 11 is connected to the first port 2 via the inductor L1, whereby the LC resonator 11 is electrically connected to the first port 2. The other ends of the inductor L14 and the capacitor C14 of the LC resonator 14 are connected to the second port 3 via the inductor L2, whereby the LC resonator 14 is electrically connected to the second port 3.

(31) Note that the inductors L1 and L2 are not indispensable components of the filter device 1, and may be omitted. In such a case, the one end of each of the inductor L11 and the capacitor C11 of the LC resonator 11 is directly connected to the first port 2, whereby the LC resonator 11 is electrically connected to the first port 2. Moreover, in such a case, the other ends of the inductor L14 and the capacitor C14 of the LC resonator 14 are directly connected to the second port 3, whereby the LC resonator 14 is electrically connected to the second port 3.

(32) Next, other configurations of the filter device 1 will be described with reference to FIG. 2. FIG. 2 is a perspective view showing an outside view of the filter device 1.

(33) The filter device 1 further includes a stack 50 including a plurality of dielectric layers and a plurality of conductor layers stacked together. The first port 2, the second port 3, the LC resonators 11 to 14, the inductors L1 to L3, and the capacitors C1 to C10 are integrated with the stack 50.

(34) The stack 50 has a bottom surface 50A and a top surface 50B located at both ends in a stacking direction T of the plurality of dielectric layers, and four side surfaces 50C to 50F connecting the bottom surface 50A and the top surface 50B. The side surfaces 50C and 50D are opposite to each other. The side surfaces 50E and 50F are opposite to each other. The side surfaces 50C to 50F are perpendicular to the top surface 50B and the bottom surface 50A.

(35) Here, as shown in FIG. 2, an X direction, a Y direction, and a Z direction are defined. The X direction, the Y direction, and the Z direction are orthogonal to one another. In the present embodiment, a direction in parallel to the stacking direction T is defined as the Z direction. A direction opposite to the X direction is defined as a -X direction, a direction opposite to the Y direction is defined as a -Y direction, and a direction opposite to the Z direction is defined as a -Z direction.

(36) As shown in FIG. 2, the bottom surface 50A is located at the end of the stack 50 in the -Z direction. The top surface 50B is located at the end of the stack 50 in the Z direction. The shape of each of the bottom surface 50A and the top surface 50B is a rectangular shape being long in the X direction. The side surface 50C is located at the end of the stack 50 in the -X direction. The side surface 50D is located at the end of the stack 50 in the X direction. The side surface 50E is located at the end of the stack 50 in the -Y direction. The side surface 50F is located at the end of the stack 50 in the Y direction.

(37) The bottom surface **50A** is opposed to a not-shown body to be mounted such as a substrate. The bottom surface **50A** corresponds to the “first surface” in the present invention. The top surface **50B** is located on the opposite side of the stack **50** to the bottom surface **50A**. The top surface **50B** corresponds to the “second surface” in the present invention.

(38) The filter device **1** further includes terminals **111**, **112**, **113**, and **114** disposed on the bottom surface **50A** of the stack **50**. The terminal **111** is located closer to the side surface **50C** than to the side surface **50D**, and extends in a direction parallel to the Y direction. The terminal **113** is located closer to the side surface **50D** than to the side surface **50C**, and extends in the direction parallel to the Y direction. The terminals **112** and **114** are located between the terminals **111** and **113**. The terminal **112** is located closer to the side surface **50E** than to the side surface **50F**. The terminal **114** is located closer to the side surface **50F** than to the side surface **50E**.

(39) The terminal **111** corresponds to the first port **2**, and the terminal **113** the second port **3**. The first and second ports **2** and **3** are thus disposed on the bottom surface **50A** of the stack **50**. Both the terminals **112** and **114** are grounded.

(40) Next, with reference to FIG. **3A** to FIG. **9C**, an example of the plurality of dielectric layers and the plurality of conductor layers constituting the stack **50** will be described. In the present example, the stack **50** includes twenty-seven dielectric layers stacked together. The twenty-seven dielectric layers are hereinafter referred to as first to twenty-seventh dielectric layers in the order from bottom to top. The first to twenty-seventh dielectric layers are denoted by reference numerals **51** to **77**.

(41) In FIG. **3A** to FIG. **9C**, each of a plurality of circles represents a through hole. The dielectric layers **51** to **75** each have a plurality of through holes. The plurality of through holes are each formed by filling a hole intended for a through hole with a conductive paste. Each of the plurality of through holes is connected to a terminal, a conductor layer or another through hole.

(42) FIG. **3A** shows a patterned surface of the first dielectric layer **51**. The terminals **111** to **114** are formed on the patterned surface of the dielectric layer **51**. FIG. **3B** shows a patterned surface of the second dielectric layer **52**. Conductor layer **521**, **522**, and **523** are formed on the patterned surface of the dielectric layer **52**.

(43) FIG. **3C** shows a patterned surface of the third dielectric layer **53**. Conductor layers **531**, **532**, **533**, and **534** are formed on the patterned surface of the dielectric layer **53**. In FIG. **3C**, two specific through holes connected to the conductor layers **531** and **532** are denoted by reference numerals **53T1** and **53T3**, respectively.

(44) FIG. **4A** shows a patterned surface of the fourth dielectric layer **54**. Conductor layers **541** and **542** are formed on the patterned surface of the dielectric layer **54**. In FIG. **4A**, two specific through holes connected to the specific through holes **53T1** and **53T3** formed in the dielectric layer **53** are denoted by reference numerals **54T1** and **54T3**, respectively.

(45) FIG. **4B** shows a patterned surface of the fifth dielectric layer **55**. Conductor layer **551**, **552**, and **553** are formed on the patterned surface of the dielectric layer **55**. In FIG. **4B**, two specific through holes connected to the specific through holes **54T1** and **54T3** formed in the dielectric layer **54** are denoted by reference numerals **55T1** and **55T3**, respectively.

(46) FIG. **4C** shows a patterned surface of the sixth dielectric layer **56**. Conductor layer **561** and **562** are formed on the patterned surface of the dielectric layer **56**. In FIG. **4C**, two specific through holes connected to the specific through holes **55T1** and **55T3** formed in the dielectric layer **55** are denoted by reference numerals **56T1** and **56T3**, respectively. Two specific through holes connected to the conductor layers **561** and **562** are denoted by reference numerals **56T5** and **56T6**, respectively.

(47) FIG. **5A** shows a patterned surface of the seventh dielectric layer **57**. Conductor layers **571** and **572** are formed on the patterned surface of the dielectric layer **57**. In FIG. **5A**, four specific through holes connected to the specific through holes **56T1**, **56T3**, **56T5**, and **56T6** formed in the dielectric layer **56** are denoted by reference numerals **57T1**, **57T3**, **57T5**, and **57T6**, respectively.

(48) FIG. 5B shows a patterned surface of the eighth dielectric layer **58**. A conductor layer **581** is formed on the patterned surface of the dielectric layer **58**. In FIG. 5B, four specific through holes connected to the specific through holes **57T1**, **57T3**, **57T5**, and **57T6** formed in the dielectric layer **57** are denoted by reference numerals **58T1**, **58T3**, **58T5**, and **58T6**, respectively.

(49) FIG. 5C shows a patterned surface of each of the ninth to fourteenth dielectric layers **59** to **64**. Specific through holes **59T1**, **59T3**, **59T5**, and **59T6** are formed in each of the dielectric layers **59** to **64**. The specific through holes **58T1**, **58T3**, **58T5**, and **58T6** formed in the dielectric layer **58** are connected respectively to the specific through holes **59T1**, **59T3**, **59T5**, and **59T6** formed in the dielectric layer **59**. The through holes having the same reference numerals in upper and lower, adjoining ones of the dielectric layers **59** to **64** are connected to each other.

(50) FIG. 6A shows a patterned surface of the fifteenth dielectric layer **65**. Inductor conductor layers **651** and **652** and conductor layers **653** and **654** are formed on the patterned surface of the dielectric layer **65**. Each of the conductor layers **653** and **654** has a first end and a second end opposite to each other. The specific through hole **59T5** formed in the dielectric layer **64** is connected to a portion of the conductor layer **653** near the first end thereof. The specific through hole **59T6** formed in the dielectric layer **64** is connected to a portion of the conductor layer **654** near the first end thereof.

(51) In FIG. 6A, two specific through holes connected to the specific through holes **59T1** and **59T3** formed in the dielectric layer **64** are denoted by reference numerals **65T1** and **65T3**, respectively. A specific through hole connected to a portion of the conductor layer **653** near the second end thereof is denoted by a reference numeral **65T2**. A specific through hole connected to a portion of the conductor layer **654** near the second end thereof is denoted by a reference numeral **65T4**. A specific through hole connected to a portion of the conductor layer **653** near the first end thereof is denoted by a reference numeral **65T5**. A specific through hole connected to a portion of the conductor layer **654** near the first end thereof is denoted by a reference numeral **65T6**.

(52) FIG. 6B shows a patterned surface of the sixteenth dielectric layer **66**. Inductor conductor layers **661** and **662** and conductor layers **663** and **664** are formed on the patterned surface of the dielectric layer **66**. Each of the conductor layers **663** and **664** has a first end and a second end opposite to each other. The specific through hole **65T2** formed in the dielectric layer **65** is connected to a portion of the conductor layer **663** near the second end thereof. The specific through hole **65T4** formed in the dielectric layer **65** is connected to a portion of the conductor layer **664** near the second end thereof. The specific through hole **65T5** formed in the dielectric layer **65** is connected to a portion of the conductor layer **663** near the first end thereof. The specific through hole **65T6** formed in the dielectric layer **65** is connected to a portion of the conductor layer **664** near the first end thereof.

(53) In FIG. 6B, two specific through holes connected to the specific through holes **65T1** and **65T3** formed in the dielectric layer **65** are denoted by reference numerals **66T1** and **66T3**, respectively. A specific through hole connected to a portion of the conductor layer **663** near the second end thereof is denoted by a reference numeral **66T2**. A specific through hole connected to a portion of the conductor layer **664** near the second end thereof is denoted by a reference numeral **66T4**.

(54) FIG. 6C shows a patterned surface of the seventeenth dielectric layer **67**. Inductor conductor layers **671** and **672** are formed on the patterned surface of the dielectric layer **67**. In FIG. 6C, four specific through holes connected to the specific through holes **66T1**, **66T2**, **66T3**, and **66T4** formed in the dielectric layer **66** are denoted by reference numerals **67T1**, **67T2**, **67T3**, and **67T4**, respectively.

(55) FIG. 7A shows a patterned surface of the eighteenth dielectric layer **68**. Inductor conductor layers **681** and **682** are formed on the patterned surface of the dielectric layer **68**. In FIG. 7A, four specific through holes connected to the specific through holes **67T1**, **67T2**, **67T3**, and **67T4** formed in the dielectric layer **67** are denoted by reference numerals **68T1**, **68T2**, **68T3**, and **68T4**, respectively.

(56) FIG. 7B shows a patterned surface of the nineteenth dielectric layer **69**. Inductor conductor layers **691** and **692** are formed on the patterned surface of the dielectric layer **69**. In FIG. 7B, four specific through holes connected to the specific through holes **68T1**, **68T2**, **68T3**, and **68T4** formed in the dielectric layer **68** are denoted by reference numerals **69T1**, **69T2**, **69T3**, and **69T4**, respectively.

(57) FIG. 7C shows a patterned surface of the twentieth dielectric layer **70**. Inductor conductor layers **701** and **702** are formed on the patterned surface of the dielectric layer **70**. In FIG. 7C, four specific through holes connected to the specific through holes **69T1**, **69T2**, **69T3**, and **69T4** formed in the dielectric layer **69** are denoted by reference numerals **70T1**, **70T2**, **70T3**, and **70T4**, respectively.

(58) FIG. 8A shows a patterned surface of the twenty-first dielectric layer **71**. Inductor conductor layers **711** and **712** are formed on the patterned surface of the dielectric layer **71**. In FIG. 8A, four specific through holes connected to the specific through holes **70T1**, **70T2**, **70T3**, and **70T4** formed in the dielectric layer **70** are denoted by reference numerals **71T1**, **71T2**, **71T3**, and **71T4**, respectively.

(59) FIG. 8B shows a patterned surface of the twenty-second dielectric layer **72**. Inductor conductor layers **721** and **722** are formed on the patterned surface of the dielectric layer **72**. In FIG. 8B, four specific through holes connected to the specific through holes **71T1**, **71T2**, **71T3**, and **71T4** formed in the dielectric layer **71** are denoted by reference numerals **72T1**, **72T2**, **72T3**, and **72T4**, respectively.

(60) FIG. 8C shows a patterned surface of each of the twenty-third and twenty-fourth dielectric layers **73** and **74**. Specific through holes **73T1**, **73T2**, **73T3**, and **73T4** are formed in each of the dielectric layers **73** and **74**. The specific through holes **72T1** to **72T4** formed in the dielectric layer **72** are connected respectively to the specific through holes **73T1** to **73T4** formed in the dielectric layer **73**. Upper and lower, adjoining through holes having the same reference numerals in the dielectric layers **73** and **74** are connected to each other.

(61) FIG. 9A shows a patterned surface of the twenty-fifth dielectric layer **75**. Inductor conductor layers **751** and **752** are formed on the patterned surface of the dielectric layer **75**. Each of the conductor layers **751** and **752** has a first end and a second end opposite to each other. The specific through hole **73T1** formed in the dielectric layer **74** is connected to a portion of the conductor layer **751** near the first end thereof. The specific through hole **73T2** formed in the dielectric layer **74** is connected to a portion of the conductor layer **751** near the second end thereof. The specific through hole **73T3** formed in the dielectric layer **74** is connected to a portion of the conductor layer **752** near the first end thereof. The specific through hole **73T4** formed in the dielectric layer **74** is connected to a portion of the conductor layer **752** near the second end thereof.

(62) In FIG. 9A, a specific through hole connected to a portion of the conductor layer **751** near the first end thereof is denoted by a reference numeral **75T1**. A specific through hole connected to a portion of the conductor layer **751** near the second end thereof is denoted by a reference numeral **75T2**. A specific through hole connected to a portion of the conductor layer **752** near the first end thereof is denoted by a reference numeral **75T3**. A specific through hole connected to a portion of the conductor layer **752** near the second end thereof is denoted by a reference numeral **75T4**.

(63) FIG. 9B shows a patterned surface of the twenty-sixth dielectric layer **76**. Inductor conductor layers **761** and **762** are formed on the patterned surface of the dielectric layer **76**. Each of the conductor layers **761** and **762** has a first end and a second end opposite to each other. The specific through hole **75T1** formed in the dielectric layer **75** is connected to a portion of the conductor layer **761** near the first end thereof. The specific through hole **75T2** formed in the dielectric layer **75** is connected to a portion of the conductor layer **761** near the second end thereof. The specific through hole **75T3** formed in the dielectric layer **75** is connected to a portion of the conductor layer **762** near the first end thereof. The specific through hole **75T4** formed in the dielectric layer **75** is connected to a portion of the conductor layer **762** near the second end thereof.

(64) FIG. 9C shows a patterned surface of the twenty-seventh dielectric layer 77. A mark 771 formed of a conductor layer is formed on the patterned surface of the dielectric layer 77.

(65) The stack 50 shown in FIG. 2 is formed by stacking the first to twenty-seventh dielectric layers 51 to 77 such that the patterned surface of the first dielectric layer 51 serves as the bottom surface 50A of the stack 50 and the surface of the twenty-seventh dielectric layer 77 opposite to the patterned surface thereof serves as the top surface 50B of the stack 50.

(66) Each of the through holes shown in FIG. 3A to FIG. 8A except for the plurality of specific through holes denoted by the reference numerals is connected to a conductor layer overlapping in the stacking direction T or another through hole overlapping in the stacking direction T when the first to twenty-seventh dielectric layers 51 to 77 are stacked. Of the through holes shown in FIG. 3A to FIG. 8A except for the plurality of specific through holes, ones located within a terminal or conductor layer are connected to the terminal or conductor layer.

(67) FIG. 10 and FIG. 11 show the internal structure of the stack 50 constituted by stacking the first to twenty-seventh dielectric layers 51 to 77. FIG. 10 shows the internal structure of the stack 50 as seen from the side surface 50D and 50E side. FIG. 11 shows the internal structure of the stack 50 as seen from the side surface 50C and 50F side. As shown in FIG. 10 and FIG. 11, the plurality of conductor layers and the plurality of through holes shown in FIG. 3A to FIG. 9C are stacked together inside the stack 50. In FIG. 10 and FIG. 11, the mark 771 is omitted.

(68) A correspondence between the circuit components of the filter device 1 shown in FIG. 1 and the internal components of the stack 50 shown in FIG. 3A to FIG. 9B will now be described. The inductor L11 of the LC resonator 11 is composed of the inductor conductor layers 751 and 761 and the specific through holes 53T1, 54T1, 55T1, 56T1, 57T1, 58T1, 59T1, 65T1, 66T1, 66T2, 67T1, 67T2, 68T1, 68T2, 69T1, 69T2, 70T1, 70T2, 71T1, 71T2, 72T1, 72T2, 73T1, 73T2, 75T1, and 75T2. The capacitor C11 of the LC resonator 11 is composed of the conductor layers 531 and 541 and the dielectric layer 53 between the conductor layers.

(69) The inductor L12 of the LC resonator 12 is composed of the inductor conductor layers 651, 661, 671, 681, 691, 701, 711, and 721, and the plurality of through holes connected to the conductor layers. The capacitor C12 of the LC resonator 12 is composed of the conductor layers 521 and 551 and the dielectric layers 52 to 54 between the conductor layers.

(70) The inductor L13 of the LC resonator 13 is composed of the inductor conductor layers 652, 662, 672, 682, 692, 702, 712, and 722, and the plurality of through holes connected to the conductor layers. The capacitor C13 of the LC resonator 13 is composed of the conductor layers 521 and 552 and the dielectric layers 52 to 54 between the conductor layers.

(71) The inductor L14 of the LC resonator 14 is composed of the inductor conductor layers 752 and 762 and the specific through holes 53T3, 54T3, 55T3, 56T3, 57T3, 58T3, 59T3, 65T3, 66T3, 66T4, 67T3, 67T4, 68T3, 68T4, 69T3, 69T4, 70T3, 70T4, 71T3, 71T4, 72T3, 72T4, 73T3, 73T4, 75T3, and 75T4. The capacitor C14 of the LC resonator 14 is composed of the conductor layers 532 and 542 and the dielectric layer 53 between the conductor layers.

(72) The capacitor C1 is composed of the conductor layers 521 and 531 and the dielectric layer 52 between the conductor layers. The capacitor C2 is composed of the conductor layers 533 and 541 and the dielectric layer 53 between the conductor layers.

(73) The capacitor C3 is composed of the conductor layers 541, 551, 561, and 571, and the dielectric layers 54 to 56 between the conductor layers. The capacitor C4 is composed of the conductor layers 571, 572, and 581, and the dielectric layer 57 between the conductor layers. The capacitor C5 is composed of the conductor layers 542, 552, 562, and 572, and the dielectric layers 54 to 56 between the conductor layers.

(74) The capacitor C6 is composed of the dielectric layers 534 and 542 and the dielectric layer 53 between the conductor layers. The capacitor C7 is composed of the conductor layers 521 and 532 and the dielectric layer 52 between the conductor layers.

(75) The capacitor C8 is composed of the conductor layers 541 and 552 and the dielectric layer 54

between the conductor layers. The capacitor C9 is composed of the conductor layers 542 and 551 and the dielectric layer 54 between the conductor layers. The capacitor C10 is composed of the conductor layers 541, 542, and 553 and the dielectric layer 54 between the conductor layers.

(76) The inductor L1 is composed of the conductors (including the conductor layer 522) connecting the terminal 111 and the conductor layer 531. The inductor L2 is composed of the conductors (including the conductor layer 523) connecting the terminal 113 and the conductor layer 532. The inductor L3 is composed of the conductor layer 521, the plurality of through holes connecting the terminals 112 and 114 and the conductor layer 521, the conductors (including the conductor layer 535) connecting the inductor conductor layer 711 and the conductor layer 521, and the conductors (including the conductor layer 536) connecting the inductor conductor layer 712 and the conductor layer 521.

(77) Next, structural characteristics of the filter device 1 according to the present embodiment will be described with reference to FIG. 2 to FIG. 11. As employed herein, a structure formed by connecting two or more through holes in series will be referred to as a through hole line. The stack 50 includes through hole lines T1, T2, T3, and T4. The through hole line T1 is composed of the specific through holes 53T1, 54T1, 55T1, 56T1, 57T1, 58T1, 59T1, 65T1, 66T1, 67T1, 68T1, 69T1, 70T1, 71T1, 72T1, 73T1, and 75T1. The through hole line T2 is composed of the specific through holes 66T2, 67T2, 68T2, 69T2, 70T2, 71T2, 72T2, 73T2, and 75T2. The through hole line T3 is composed of the specific through holes 53T3, 54T3, 55T3, 56T3, 57T3, 58T3, 59T3, 65T3, 66T3, 67T3, 68T3, 69T3, 70T3, 71T3, 72T3, 73T3, and 75T3. The through hole line T4 is composed of the specific through holes 66T4, 67T4, 68T4, 69T4, 70T4, 71T4, 72T4, 73T4, and 75T4.

(78) The inductor L11 of the LC resonator 11 includes the through hole lines T1 and T2 and the inductor conductor layers 751 and 761. The inductor L14 of the LC resonator 14 includes the through hole lines T3 and T4 and the inductor conductor layers 752 and 762. Each of the inductor conductor layers 751 and 761 connects the through hole lines T1 and T2. Each of the inductor conductor layers 752 and 762 connects the through hole lines T3 and T4.

(79) Each of the through hole lines T1 and T2 corresponds to the “first through hole line” in the present invention. Each of the through hole lines T3 and T4 corresponds to the “second through hole line” in the present invention. Each of the inductor conductor layers 751 and 761 corresponds to the “first conductor layer” in the present invention. Each of the inductor conductor layers 752 and 762 corresponds to the “second conductor layer” in the present invention.

(80) The inductors L11 and L14 are configured to be magnetically coupled inside the stack 50. In particular, in the present embodiment, the inductors L11 and L14 are located to adjoin inside the stack 50 for the sake of magnetic coupling. Specifically, the through hole lines T1 and T2 of the inductor L11 and the through holes lines T3 and T4 of the inductor L14 are located near the center of the stack 50 in the direction parallel to the Y direction (longitudinal directions of the bottom surface 50A and the top surface 50B) and adjoin each other inside the stack 50. No conductor exists between the through hole lines T1 and T3 or between the through hole lines T2 and T4. Moreover, the inductor conductor layers 751 and 761 of the inductor L11 and the inductor conductor layers 752 and 762 of the inductor L14 adjoin inside the stack 50. No conductor exists between the inductor conductor layers 751 and 752 or between the inductor conductor layers 761 and 762.

(81) Now, a region sandwiched between the through hole lines T1 and T2 will be referred to as a first region. A region sandwiched between the through hole lines T3 and T4 will be referred to as a second region. The first region and the second region overlap with each other when seen in the Y direction, i.e., when the first and second regions are seen from a position in front of the stack 50 in the Y direction. The first and second regions may be the same when seen in the Y direction.

(82) The inductor conductor layer 751 and the inductor conductor layer 752 do not overlap with each other when seen in the Z direction, i.e., when the inductor conductor layers 751 and 752 are seen from a position in front of the stack 50 in the Z direction. Similarly, the inductor conductor

layer **761** and the inductor conductor layer **762** do not overlap with each other when seen in the Z direction, i.e., when the inductor conductor layers **761** and **762** are seen from a position in front of the stack **50** in the Z direction.

(83) Each of the inductor conductor layers **751** and **752** has a planar U-shape. More specifically, the inductor conductor layer **751** includes two portions that extend in a direction away from the inductor conductor layer **752** ($-X$ direction), and a portion that connects the two portions and extends in the direction parallel to the Y direction. The inductor conductor layer **752** includes two portions that extend in a direction away from the inductor conductor layer **751** (X direction), and a portion that connects the two portions and extends in the direction parallel to the Y direction.

(84) Similarly, each of the inductor conductor layers **761** and **762** has a planar U-shape. More specifically, the inductor conductor layer **761** includes two portions that extend in a direction away from the inductor conductor layer **762** ($-X$ direction), and a portion that connects the two portions and extends in the direction parallel to the Y direction. The inductor conductor layer **762** includes two portions that extend in a direction away from the inductor conductor layer **761** (X direction), and a portion that connects the two portions and extends in the direction parallel to the Y direction.

(85) The inductor conductor layers **651**, **661**, **671**, **681**, **691**, **701**, **711**, and **721** constituting the inductor **L12** of the LC resonator **12** overlap the region where the inductor conductor layers **751** and **761** are located when seen in the Z direction. The inductor conductor layers **651**, **661**, **671**, **681**, **691**, **701**, **711**, and **721** may overlap the inductor conductor layers **751** and **761** themselves, or overlap the region surrounded by the inductor conductor layers **751** and **761**.

(86) The inductor conductor layers **652**, **662**, **672**, **682**, **692**, **702**, **712**, and **722** constituting the inductor **L13** of the LC resonator **13** overlap the region where the inductor conductor layers **752** and **762** are located when seen in the Z direction. The inductor conductor layers **652**, **662**, **672**, **682**, **692**, **702**, **712**, and **722** may overlap the inductor conductor layers **752** and **762** themselves, or overlap the region surrounded by the inductor conductor layers **752** and **762**.

(87) Next, operation and effects of the filter device **1** according to the present embodiment will be described. In the present embodiment, the inductors **L11** and **L14** are configured to be magnetically coupled inside the stack **50**. According to the present embodiment, a pass characteristic changing sharply at a frequency range near a cut-off frequency can thereby be implemented. This effect will now be described with reference to simulation results.

(88) The simulation used a model of the structure of the filter device **1** shown in FIG. **2** to FIG. **11** and a model of the circuit of the filter device **1** shown in FIG. **1**. Both the structure model and the circuit model were configured as a model of the band-pass filter. In the circuit model, the inductors **L11** and **L14** were not magnetically coupled.

(89) In the simulation, the structure model and the circuit model were designed so that the structure model and the circuit model had substantially the same passbands, and insertion loss and return loss in the respective passbands of the structure model and the circuit model were substantially the same.

(90) FIG. **12** to FIG. **14** are characteristic charts showing pass characteristics obtained by the simulation. In FIG. **12** to FIG. **14**, the horizontal axis indicates the frequency, and the vertical axis the attenuation. FIG. **13** shows a frequency range in the vicinity of the passband in an enlarged scale. FIG. **14** shows a frequency range near the upper cut-off frequency of the passband. In FIG. **12** to FIG. **14**, the curve denoted by the reference numeral **91** indicates the pass characteristic of the structure model. The curve denoted by the reference numeral **92** indicates the pass characteristic of the circuit model.

(91) As shown in FIG. **14**, it can be seen that the structure model (reference numeral **91**) changes sharply in the attenuation at the frequency range near the upper cut-off frequency, compared to the circuit model (reference numeral **92**). The structure model is different from the circuit model in that the inductors **L11** and **L14** are configured to be magnetically coupled inside the stack **50**. As can be seen from the simulation results, according to the present embodiment, a pass characteristic

changing sharply at a frequency range near a cut-off frequency can be implemented by configuring the inductors **L11** and **L14** to be magnetically coupled inside the stack **50**.

(92) A pass characteristic changing sharply at a frequency range near a cut-off frequency can also be implemented by increasing the number of LC resonators. However, the greater the number of LC resonators, the more difficult the filter device is to downsize. By contrast, according to the present embodiment, the filter device **1** can be downsized since the foregoing pass characteristic can be implemented without increasing the number of LC resonators.

(93) Next, other effects of the present embodiment will be described. In the present embodiment, the through hole lines **T1** and **T2** of the inductor **L11** and the through hole lines **T3** and **T4** of the inductor **L14** are located inside the stack **50**, near the center of the stack **50** in the direction parallel to the Y direction. The inductor conductor layers **751** and **752** (**761** and **762**) are shaped to extend in the directions away from each other. In the present embodiment, components of the filter device **1** can thus be located on the bottom surface **50A** side of the inductor conductor layers **751** and **752** (**761** and **762**). In the present embodiment, the inductor **L12** is located on the bottom surface **50A** side of the inductor conductor layer **751** (**761**), and the inductor **L13** is located on the bottom surface **50A** side of the inductor conductor layer **752** (**762**). According to the present embodiment, the space inside the stack **50** can thus be efficiently used to downsize the filter device **1**.

(94) Note that the present invention is not limited to the foregoing embodiment, and various modifications can be made thereto. For example, a filter device according to the present invention may only include either one of the LC resonators **12** and **13**. Alternatively, one or more LC resonators may be provided between the LC resonators **11** and **12** or between the LC resonators **13** and **14**.

(95) Obviously, many modifications and variations of the present invention are possible in the light of the above teachings. Thus, it is to be understood that, within the scope of the appended claims and equivalents thereof, the invention may be practiced in other embodiments than the foregoing most preferable embodiment.

Claims

1. A multilayered filter device comprising: a first port; a second port; a first LC resonator electrically connected to the first port; a second LC resonator electrically connected to the second port; a third LC resonator provided between the first LC resonator and the second LC resonator in a circuit configuration; and a stack that includes a plurality of dielectric layers stacked together, and that is configured to integrate the first port, the second port, the first LC resonator, the second LC resonator, and the third LC resonator, wherein the first LC resonator includes a first inductor that is electrically connected to the first port via a conductor and is not directly connected to a ground, the second LC resonator includes a second inductor that is electrically connected to the second port via a conductor and is not directly connected to the ground, and the first inductor and the second inductor are configured to be magnetically coupled inside the stack.
2. The multilayered filter device according to claim 1, wherein the first inductor and the second inductor adjoin inside the stack.
3. The multilayered filter device according to claim 1, wherein: the first inductor includes two first through hole lines and a first conductor layer connecting the two first through hole lines; the second inductor includes two second through hole lines and a second conductor layer connecting the two second through hole lines; and each of the two first through hole lines and the two second through hole lines is formed by connecting two or more through holes in series.
4. The multilayered filter device according to claim 3, wherein no conductor exists between the two first through hole lines and the two second through hole lines.
5. The multilayered filter device according to claim 3, wherein a first region sandwiched between the two first through hole lines and a second region sandwiched between the two second through

- hole lines overlap with each other when seen in a direction orthogonal to a stacking direction of the plurality of dielectric layers.
6. The multilayered filter device according to claim 3, wherein the first conductor layer and the second conductor layer do not overlap with each other when seen in a direction parallel to a stacking direction of the plurality of dielectric layers.
7. The multilayered filter device according to claim 3, wherein: the first conductor layer includes a portion that extends in a direction away from the second conductor layer; and the second conductor layer includes a portion that extends in a direction away from the first conductor layer.
8. The multilayered filter device according to claim 3, wherein: the third LC resonator includes a third inductor; the third inductor includes a third conductor layer; and the third conductor layer overlaps a region where the first conductor layer or the second conductor layer is located when seen in a direction parallel to a stacking direction of the plurality of dielectric layers.
9. The multilayered filter device according to claim 8, wherein: the stack has a first surface opposed to a body to be mounted, and a second surface opposite the first surface; and the third conductor layer is located between the first conductor layer or the second conductor layer and the first surface.
10. The multilayered filter device according to claim 1, wherein: each of the first LC resonator and the second LC resonator constitutes a low-pass filter; and the third LC resonator constitutes a high-pass filter.
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